Adding and Subtracting Unlike Fractions

Building common denominators, then adding and subtracting unlike fractions and mixed numbers

Directions

- Fractions can only be added or subtracted when the pieces are the same size — that is, when the denominators match.
- Find a common denominator first, rewrite each fraction with it, and only then add or subtract the numerators.
- Show the rewritten fractions in your work, not just the final answer.
- Give every answer in lowest terms, and write mixed numbers instead of top-heavy fractions.

1. Rewrite $\frac{1}{2}$ as an equivalent fraction with a denominator of 8. What is the missing numerator?

Answer: ____________________

2. Fill in the missing numerator: $\frac{3}{4} = \frac{}{12}$

Answer: ____________________

3. Rewrite $\frac{5}{6}$ and $\frac{3}{8}$ as equivalent fractions that both have the common denominator 24.

Answer: ________________

4. Add. Give the answer in lowest terms. $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}$

Answer: ________________

5. Add. Give the answer in lowest terms. $\frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{6}$

Answer: ________________

6. Subtract. Give the answer in lowest terms. $\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{6}$

Answer: ________________

7. Find the least common denominator of $\frac{3}{8}$ and $\frac{5}{12}$, then rewrite each fraction with that denominator.

Answer: ________________

8. Add. Give the answer in lowest terms. $\frac{5}{8} + \frac{1}{3}$

Answer: ________________

9. Subtract. Give the answer in lowest terms. $\dfrac{5}{6} - \dfrac{3}{10}$

Answer: ________________

10. Add the mixed numbers. Give the answer as a mixed number in lowest terms. $2\,\dfrac{1}{2} + 1\,\dfrac{1}{3}$

Answer: ________________

11. Subtract the mixed numbers. You will need to regroup. Give the answer as a mixed number in lowest terms. $4\,\dfrac{3}{4} - 1\,\dfrac{5}{6}$

Answer: ________________

12. A muffin recipe uses $\frac{2}{3}$ of a cup of flour and $\frac{3}{4}$ of a cup of oats. How many cups of dry ingredients does the recipe use in all? Give the answer as a mixed number in lowest terms.

Answer: ________________